



From the latest launches and scientific findings to professional picks and tips, Sigourney Cantelo makes sense of scents.

Vogue's ultimate guide to fragrance

The fragrance industry may take its cues from fashion, pop culture and science, yet at its heart it is powered by a very human fascination with emotion and memory. If you've ever wondered why the whiff of wet asphalt can transport you back 20 years to recess in the school playground, or why the scent of a stranger can send you tumbling back into the arms of an old lover, it's because of all the senses smell has the most direct correlation to recollection. We have the ability to detect around 10,000 distinct scents, each acting as a signifier to moments in our life, a phenomenon that's been described as Proustian memory (after a theory explored by Marcel Proust in his epic novel *In Search of Lost Time*). This is because smells are processed in the limbic lobe, the part of our brain that is responsible for our most primitive and instinctive reactions. As fragrances can evoke such emotional responses, it's no wonder they are such big business. In Australia last year, the retail perfume market was worth \$708.8 million and, despite recent financial fire and brimstone, the sector experienced growth of 7.1 per cent for the first half of 2009. According to perfume guru Michael Edwards, 850 new fragrances have already been launched in Australia this year alone, a figure that he predicts will balloon to 1,500 by the year's end. What better time to start the hunt for a new scent ... or two? After all, you wouldn't wear the same little black dress day in and day out, so why be limited with your olfactory outfit? As Paloma Picasso so aptly put it: "A perfume is like a piece of clothing, a message, a way of presenting oneself ... a costume that differs according to the woman who wears it."

How to ... Be in the know with your nose.

The latest olfactory offerings you need to know about: your Christmas wish list starts here.

Guerlain Idylle EDP, 50ml for \$149.

Need to know When formulating Guerlain's latest scent, house perfumer Thierry Wasser was in love and wanted Idylle to represent a joyous romance.

Nose notes Subtle and feminine, this is like standing under a shower of petals of Bulgarian rose, lilac, peony, freesia and jasmine. There's also a sweetness in there, of raspberry and lychee.

Prada L'eau Ambrée EDP, 80ml for \$195.

Need to know The latest addition to the Prada Classic family of Amber, Amber Intense and Amber pour Homme, this fashion-savvy scent is the perfect choice for the floral-shy.

Nose notes A fresh burst of citron smooths down to reveal just a hint of rose and a base of addictive amber that is both subtle and understated.

Alberta Ferretti EDP, 75ml for \$178.

Need to know Known for her sumptuous fabrics and soft silhouettes, Italian designer Alberta Ferretti's first foray into fragrance is set to become a modern classic. The glass bottle is luxuriously heavy and faceted like a precious gem.

Nose notes At first whiff it sparkles with sunshine and flowers, like a garden table overflowing with vases of freshly picked lilies, freesia and sweetpea.

Marc Jacobs Lola EDT, 50ml for \$120.

Need to know Jacobs designed the bottles to resemble chic vintage vases holding a lid of wacky vinyl flowers.

Nose notes Designed to be the older sister to his hit scent Daisy, Lola is light, flowery and very wearable. A splash of pear and grapefruit is dressed up with whiffs of rose, peony and vanilla.

D&G La Lune EDT, 100ml for \$99.

Need to know The über-cool Mario Testino ad campaign rallies 90s supermodels Eva Herzigova, Claudia Schiffer and Naomi Campbell, who strut to the nostalgic beat of George Michael's *Freedom*.

Nose notes One of five scents inspired by French tarot cards, soft tuberose and lily mingle with fresh apple and a cool, smooth leather note that reminds you of designer handbags and luxury car seats.

Idole d'Armani EDP, 50ml for \$130.

Need to know This elegant floral is Giorgio Armani's tribute to women everywhere. Armani created the sleek spherical bottle himself, inspired by 1930s style.

Nose notes This is sophistication in a bottle. Pear and ginger martinis spring to mind, then there are the lingering hints of jasmine and rose.

Yves Saint Laurent Parisienne EDP, 90ml for \$155.

Need to know Kate Moss stars in the campaign as a sexy, free-spirited Yves Saint Laurent-clad Parisienne who relishes steamy flashbacks from the night before. The rippled glass of the bottle is designed to symbolise the wrinkled sheets of the bed she has just left.

Nose notes Rose and violet are at the heart of this sexy scent, which is made modern by a "vinyl" note – a blend of sweet blackberry and tart cranberry.

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How to ...

Shop for perfume like a professional.

To navigate those shiny department store shelves, it pays to understand what kind of scents you are attracted to. Like the wine industry, the fragrance world has its own classification system, based around the perfume's most dominant notes. In an effort to demystify the esoteric world of fragrance, Michael Edwards, author of the annual *Fragrances of the World* guide, came up with the concept of the "fragrance wheel".

To determine the category that most appeals to you, find a fragrance you like

around the outside of the wheel and note which family it falls under.

You can try another fragrance in the same family or, for a bit of a twist, Edwards suggests moving around the wheel by one category to try something new.

If your favourite fragrance isn't listed here, you can head to a department store and ask the beauty advisors to consult the *Fragrances of the World* book or web site (www.fragrancesoftheworld.com; subscription required). They can look up your favourite fragrances, tell you which family you fall under, and give you some suggestions to try.

Only test two or three fragrances at a time, to avoid olfactory overload.

Clockwise from top left: Vera Wang EDP, 50ml for \$120; Chanel No 5 Eau Première, 150ml for \$245; Thierry Mugler Alien EDP, 60ml for \$150; Versace Crystal Noir EDP, 50ml for \$100; Guerlain Maison Les Elixirs Charnels Oriental Brûlant EDP, 75ml for \$305; Yves Saint Laurent Opium EDT, 100ml for \$204; Giorgio Armani Onde Mystère EDP, 50ml for \$145; Dior Addict EDP, 50ml for \$130; Prada EDP, 80ml for \$185; Viktor & Rolf Flowerbomb EDP, 50ml for \$159; Estée Lauder Sensuous EDP, 50ml for \$110; Bulgari Jasmin Noir EDT, 50ml for \$115; Narciso Rodriguez for Her EDT, 50ml for \$119; Gucci by Gucci EDP, 50ml for \$120; Editions de Parfums Frédéric Malle Dans tes bras, 50ml for \$260; Donna Karan Cashmere Mist EDP, 50ml for \$116; Dior Escale à Pondichéry, 75ml for \$110; Chanel Cristalle Eau Verte EDT, 100ml for \$165; Anna Sui Rock Me! EDT, 50ml for \$89; Escada Ocean Lounge EDT, 100ml for \$99; A Scent by Issey Miyake EDT, 50ml for \$119; Issey Miyake L'Eau D'Issey EDT, 100ml for \$200; Calvin Klein Escape EDP, 100ml for \$95; Chloé EDP, 50ml for \$120; Michael Kors EDP, 50ml for \$138.



How to ...

Use scent to snare and seduce

Throughout history, fragrance has always been a particularly reliable arrow in Cupid's quiver. Before she received her lovers, Cleopatra would rub her mouth with solid perfume and carpet her boudoir ankle-deep in rose petals. In ancient Greece, scents were believed to enhance love-making, while the Romans rubbed perfume on the soles of their feet. Scent remains a major tool in the art of seduction – and apparently a big consideration for men. In *The Scent of Desire* (HarperCollins), the men that author Rachel Herz interviewed ranked what a woman smells like as more important than how her skin feels or how her voice sounds. In an effort to understand perfume's true pulling power, we asked the world's top male perfumers and fragrance experts to reveal the most alluring ways to wear and select scent.

Choose your weapon

"Fragrances are all about seduction: they can almost become psychological weapons. I know women who use a different fragrance for each type of message they want to send. One was using a tuberose-based scent at her workplace and an orange-flower perfume on the weekends with her boyfriend," says Bruno Jovanovic, the perfumer behind *Idole d'Armani*. Perfume "publisher" Frédéric Malle also considers tuberose a particularly bewitching bloom. "It catches you by surprise," Malle says. "It is a flower that smells like a sensuous person: it's almost surreal." Dior nose François Demachy believes that amber is the ultimate aphrodisiac. "Whenever I smell amber I'm transported to a dark and boudoir-ish place," he says.

Be a kiss magnet

"Mademoiselle [Chanel] used to say: 'Wear perfume where you wish to be kissed.' I find this very poetic – it's a beautiful way to apply perfume, thinking of the areas you would like to be kissed by the man who you love," says Chanel nose Jacques Polge. Jacques Cavallier, the perfumer behind *Blu Eau de Parfum II*, Bulgari's newest fragrance, agrees: "Wearing it on your neck is a delicate invitation to a kiss."

Get hot and heavy

"Applying a fragrance low on the body allows the scent to rise naturally with body heat," says Danny Ventura, international training manager for Paris-based perfume developer Beauté Prestige International. "The scent will envelop you – and those who you allow to get close will enjoy it as well." Polge says you should always apply perfume directly on the skin: "It gets warmer, it becomes alive. It creates an alchemy which is going to express the perfume in a more personalised and sensual way."

“What remains of a woman when she is in the dark? When she has undressed, when we can no longer see her make-up, her wonderful hair, her beautiful eyes, when she's taken off her jewellery, what is left? Only her charming voice and her perfume ...”
Jean-Paul Guerlain

Scent your strands

"I have a weakness for women who perfume their hair tips," says Jovanovic. "Each movement releases a sensual trail that hooks you in a trap. It's magical and alchemical."

Good enough to eat

Although pheromones play a big part in the olfactory mating dance, recent studies have pinpointed certain odours that are sure-fire fire-starters. Dr Alan Hirsch, a neurologist and founder of the Smell & Taste Treatment and Research Foundation in Chicago, found that men who were exposed to lavender, doughnuts and vanilla were physiologically aroused.

For your own love potion, try a fragrance that contains lavender, such as Vera Wang Sheer Veil EDP, 100ml for \$170, or sweet gourmand notes, like Thierry Mugler Angel, 25ml for \$115.





How to ...

Perfume your pooch

According to *Bondi Vet's* Dr Chris Brown, it's not a good idea to spritz your puppy with your own perfume. "Things that are made for our skin's pH are often too acidic and can burn dogs," he says. "They also have a highly sensitive nose and fragrances can be way too strong, causing them to get very anxious." Best to stick to products designed specifically with woman's best friend in mind, like Juicy Couture's Juicy Crittoure set for the Decadent Doggy (\$88, available exclusively from David Jones). It contains Shampoooch, Coif Fur conditioner and a chic doggy Pawfum with notes of orange flower, jasmine and vanilla.



How to ...

Protect your investments

Fragrances contain volatile ingredients that can be affected by intense light and heat. To keep your fragrances fresher for longer, Dior perfumer François Demachy suggests keeping them in a dark cupboard. "Treat fragrance like a living thing: like wine, it should be stored in a cool place, away from changing temperatures and light," he says. In the height of summer, Michael Edwards suggests storing your most precious perfumes in the vegetable crisper in your fridge.

How to ...

Get him out of a fragrance rut

Whether you're dropping hints about his need for a new man-scent or looking to buy a gift, things just got a whole lot easier.



He likes:

Leafy-like freshness made sexy with spices and incense.

Scents he wears:

Polo Ralph Lauren, Prada Men.

GET HIM TO TRY:

Gucci by Gucci Pour Homme EDT, 50ml for \$91. This decidedly sensual scent conjures images of tall, dark men who smell of bergamot, tobacco and leather, and who leave behind a more-ish trail of incense.

He likes:

Manly, fresh, herbaceous after-shaves.

Scents he wears:

Hugo Boss Hugo, Tommy Hilfiger Tommy.

GET HIM TO TRY:

DKNY Men Summer 09 EDT, 100ml for \$89. This smells exactly how you would imagine a freshly shaved man to smell: there's a clean soapiness mingled with fresh bergamot and a snuggle-worthy base of sandalwood and cocoa beans.



He likes:

The aquatic aromas of salty breezes.

Scents he wears:

Giorgio Armani Aqua Di Giò, Issey Miyake L'Eau D'Issey Pour Homme.

GET HIM TO TRY:

Bulgari Aqua Marine Pour Homme EDT, 50ml for \$99. This scent opens with the ocean, all watery depths and darkness, then adds get-up-and-go grapefruit and neck-nuzzling cedarwood.



He likes:

Spicy mysterious scents for a night out (or in).

Scents he wears:

Gucci Rush for Men, Jean Paul Gaultier Le Male.

GET HIM TO TRY:

Yves Saint Laurent La Nuit de L'Homme, 100ml for \$135. This scent is made for private bars and the backs of cars: the hypnotic warmth of bergamot and cardamom lures you in, a seductive lick of lavender keeps your attention, and a smooth base of vetiver leaves you wanting more.

He likes:

Sporty fresh fragrances with a warm and masculine base.

Scents he wears:

Christian Dior Eau Sauvage Extrême, Versace Man Eau Fraîche.

GET HIM TO TRY:

Dior Homme Sport EDT, 100ml for \$120. The cool freshness of citrus hits you first, followed by the earthiness of ginger. This scent is energetic and striking, so it's fitting that Jude Law (of the strong jaw and piercing stare) is the face.



He likes:

Woody scents with a fresh, zingy twist.

Scents he wears:

Armani Mania Pour Homme, Christian Dior Fahrenheit.

GET HIM TO TRY:

Terre d'Hermès EDP, 75ml for \$155. The

sophisticate of the scent world (male fashionistas everywhere are wearing it) is stylish and swashbuckling while still being strong-armed and earthy. It opens with the zesty, just-washed freshness of citrus fruits, rounds out with cedarwood and finishes with an intriguing trace of gunpowder.



Sprightly scents

Research suggests that aroma can actually increase performance, acting like a double machiatto on your mental alertness. A study by the US-based Smell & Taste Treatment and Research Foundation found that when exposed to a floral scent volunteers completed puzzle-solving tasks 17 percent faster than control subjects. Mood Media, a company that develops scents for office spaces in the US, trialled a stimulating citrus scent in a call centre and discovered performance and morale improved significantly. Have a particularly demanding day ahead? Fine-tune your focus with a performance-enhancing perfume such as Jo Malone White Jasmine & Mint Cologne, 100ml for \$170, or the citrus-fresh Chanel Cristalle Eau Verte EDT, 100ml for \$165.



Gary Davey, senior cosmetics buyer, David Jones. "I adore Tom Ford's Private Blend Japon Noir. It's very distinctive, strong, spicy and makes me feel confident and masculine. People usually ask me about it, which is a great way to start a conversation and gives me confidence."



Kirsten Carriol, creator of Lanolips. "For work I wear Laura Mercier Eau de Lune. It's fresh and sweet and makes me feel fabulous and ready to take on the world."



Sylvaine Delacourte, Guerlain perfumer. "My perfume is Guerlain L'Heure Bleue: it reinforces my personality and gives me positive waves to face life's difficulties. It reminds me of my childhood, the smell of candies and waffles."



Olivier Duvillard, managing director, Elizabeth Arden Australia. "When I need extra confidence I wear Juicy Couture Dirty English. It's bold and masculine. It helps me put on my work persona."

Karla Špetić, fashion designer. "I bought Les Exclusifs de Chanel La Pausa EDT when I was on holidays in Dubrovnik. It brings back the feeling of calm and warm summer nights and leaves me in a good mood whenever I put it on, which helps me achieve more."



Alexandra Smart (far left), designer for Ginger & Smart. "I wear Le Labo Rose 31. Despite its name it is quite a woody, earthy, masculine fragrance and is confident. I love that you can only buy it in New York and Paris [the brand will soon be available at Mecca Cosmetica stores nationally] and that they mix your blend especially for you, with your name on the bottle."



Genevieve Smart, designer for Ginger & Smart. "I blend Jo Malone Red Roses and Wild Fig & Cassis. I wore this when I met with an important buyer in London, who commented on the familiarity of my fragrance yet was intrigued that she couldn't pick it. We talked for ages and the appointment went very well, which I credit to my fragrance."



How to ...

Use perfume to get what you want.

Perfume isn't just for smelling pretty: wearing fragrance affects how others perceive you in a professional situation. A 1983 experiment by US psychologist Robert Baron found that personnel managers responded more positively to female job applicants wearing perfume. Dressing for success has evolved to include a spritz of something that makes you feel fabulous, focused and capable of anything. We asked industry professionals to reveal their "power perfume".



How to ...

Smell like an icon

If the classics are more your style, look to the stars of the silver screen for a truly iconic scent.



Brigitte Bardot wore Guerlain L'Heure Bleue.



EDP, 75ml for \$192 (available on special order for Christmas only).



Lauren Bacall wore Diptyque fragrances.



Diptyque Tam Dao EDT, 100ml for \$165.



Audrey Hepburn wore Givenchy L'Interdit.

EDT, 100ml for \$135.



EDP, 30ml for \$115.



Rita Hayworth wore Guerlain Shalimar.

When asked what she wore in bed Marilyn Monroe famously said: "Chanel No 5."



Classic revival

Everything old is new again, according to a recent trend that sees the major houses raiding the archives and coming up with new spins on old successes, such as Chanel's Eau Première (a lighter, fresher take on No 5). The latest remix? Dior Diorissimo EDP, 50ml for \$130.



EDP, 50ml for \$150.



Marlene Dietrich wore Robert Piguet Fracas.

How to ...

Do niche fragrances

Aficionado Nick Smart, of boutique fragrance importer Agence de parfum and the Libertine Parfumerie stores in Brisbane, talks us through some of the world's most unique brands.

Lubin: "This 211-year-old perfume house was official perfumer to European royal courts. Gin Fizz [EDT, 50ml for \$176] was dedicated to Grace Kelly."

Juliette Has a Gun: "Romano Ricci's scents (he's the great-grandson of Nina Ricci) are modelled on a 21st-century version of Shakespeare's heroine."

Creed: "Founded in 1760, this English perfume house was official supplier to the British royal household. Grace Kelly wore Fleurissimo [75ml for \$220] on her wedding day."

Frédéric Malle: "Malle, a 'perfume publisher', collaborates with the world's best perfumers, asking them to create their dream fragrances. Editions de Parfums Frédéric Malle French Lover [EDP, 50ml for \$235] is my pick."

Serge Lutens: "As an art director and photographer, Lutens created powerful

imagery for Shiseido fragrances and Dior before creating his own line, which has an astonishingly devoted cult following." Try Une Bois Vanille, 100ml for \$175.

Jean-Charles Brosseau: "Ombre Rose [EDT, 50ml for \$143] was created by nose Françoise Caron and has received much critical acclaim."

Tocca: "These boutique scents were inspired by romantic heroines such as Cleopatra and Brigitte (Bardot)."

Miller Harris: "French-trained English perfumer Lyn Harris formulated a single scent for each perfume category, so you can build a fragrance library." Try Terre de Bois EDP, 100ml for \$180.

Bond No. 9: "Laurice Rahmé's range devotes itself to New York City, with each of the 34 fragrances named after an iconic neighbourhood." Try Bond No. 9 Park Avenue EDP, 100ml for \$290.

The bronze staircase in Serge Lutens's Parisian boutique leads to a fragrance "tasting room".



Juliette Has a Gun Lady Vengeance EDP, 100ml for \$166.